

Scores

Range:
[0, 4]

Real:
4.0

Predicted:
4.0

Prompt

Based on the excerpt, describe the obstacles the builders of the Empire State Building faced in attempting to allow dirigibles to dock there. Support your answer with relevant and specific information from the excerpt.

Essay

In the passage, "The Mooring Mast," by Marcia Amidon @CAPS1, a myriad of obstacles had faced the builders of the Empire State Building in terms of allowing dirigibles to dock there. First was the problem of constructing a mooring mast on top of the building's flat roof. Because, "a thousand-foot dirigible moored at the top of the building, held by a single cable tether, would add stress to the building's frame," the building would be unable to support the stress of both the dirigible and wind pressure. Next, safety became an issue. After the discovery that, "most dirigible's built outside the United States use hydrogen rather than helium, and hydrogen is highly flammable", owners of the Empire State Building realized the hazard involved when having a highly flammable object fly over a densely populated area. This was brought to their attention when a German dirigible was destroyed by a fire in Lakehurst, New Jersey. An addition problem was nature itself. The winds on top of the building posed the problem of having the dirigibles back end swivel around the mooring mast, seeing as weights could not be used to weight the back down since they would be dangling above pedestrians on the street. Lastly, there was, "an existing law against airships flying too low over urban areas." @CAPS2, it would be illegal for a Ship to be tied up to the building or approach the area. In light of the aforementioned reasons, it is evident that the builders of the Empire State Building faced many obstacles in attempting to allow dirigibles to dock there.

Top-10 Higher
Feature Attribution Score

